

Apskaita5 Modernization in Plain English

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In one sentence: move every customer onto one modern, cheaper system, prove their numbers match before each move, and make tax-law changes a settings update.

The problem

A Baltic company sells accounting software to 4,200 businesses. Every customer runs a private copy of it, like every family having its own house, boiler and electrician.

- Running the copies costs 3.1M EUR a year, growing with every customer.
- Tax-law changes take 10 to 14 weeks to ship; the law allows 6.
- Engineers spend 62% of their time patching 20-year-old code.

The plan

1. **One building, private apartments:** one cloud system; each customer's data locked.
2. **Tax rules become settings,** changed like a price list.
3. **Special requests become add-ons,** not custom copies.
4. **AI as a fast junior team:** it drafts, people approve.
5. **Move in small groups,** overnight, with a tested way back.

The money stays right. Before a customer moves, every ledger, VAT and payroll number must match the old system to the cent. Any difference is fixed or signed off by an accountant. AI never files taxes or pays salaries on its own.

What it buys

- **Running cost per customer:** from 738 to about 300 EUR a year.
- **Shipping a tax-law change:** from 10 to 14 weeks to under 3 weeks.
- **Engineering time on old fixes:** from 62% to 30% or less.
- **Support requests:** from 6,500 to about 3,900 a month.
- **Customers moved:** 70% by month 12, everyone by month 18.
- **Investment:** about 4M EUR over two years; pays back in under 4 years from hosting savings alone.